

1951, May 13

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O. F. M. Cap.

CAPUCIAN FRANCISCAN FATHERS
PAX ET BONUM
ST. FELIX FRIARY
HUNTINGTON, INDIANA

May 13, 1951. Feast of Pentecost.
Blessed be God. In all His designs.

Miss Lorteea Gibson
Mercy Hall
Detroit, Michigan

Dear Miss Gibson:

God bless you this glorious Feast and Easter Season, you and yours. May the divine Prince of Peace Himself breathe His Spirit of good will and harmonious enlightenment on all and each of those unselfishly interested in Mercy-Hall activity, -- present, past, future.

Glory be to God; what a record is not the story of that fair flower of Christian activity! and of practical Catholic action! -- a record of struggles sometimes bordering on the desperate, and of escapes, hair-splittingly close to disaster; struggles with and escapes from financial difficulties and bankruptcy, from envy and suspicion, from misunderstanding, calumny, etc. And some of all this in a way, before the idea of Mercy-Hall was fully conceived or its Heaven-sent "blue-prints" unfolded. -- as it was unfolded in that "miraculously" developed and unfading blooming slip of immortal from your Girl-Friend, Miss Daly's grave-- and it was definitely and urgently counseled: "Get started; if necessary, with a single patient in some old attic. God who loves tiny beginnings, will know as He always does know, how and when to provide development."

Ah! Blue prints? Struggles? Escapes? Crisis after crises? Thank God for them all. How wonderful with the inestimable gift of faith, whereby, with our cooperation, all and each such trial turn to have been blessings in disguise. Thank God too even for the present -- seemingly the supreme -- crisis. If "The memory of past difficulties is pleasant." as an old Latin proverb has it and if according to Saint Paul and every teacher of true asceticism: "It behoves us, by many tribulations to enter into the Kingdom of